

» SUMIT ANTIL

Category: Athletics (Men's Javelin Throw F64)

Sumit Antil is among a select few athletes in Indian para sports who have managed to extend their dominance across two Paralympic cycles. Sumit shot into the public spotlight when he won gold in the men's javelin F64 event at the Tokyo Paralympics, his maiden campaign in the tournament, three years ago.

He effortlessly staked his claim to the podium top step, breaking his own world record three times in the process. He finished with a world-top mark of 68.55m, which also became the new Paralympic record.

Always a sports buff, Sumit nursed ambitions to enlist for the Indian Army. Staying true to the culture in Haryana, Sumit first trained to be a wrestler, but losing a leg in a bike accident on his way home from training changed his life and career's trajectories completely.

Given his father served in the Air Force, Sumit received treatment at the Army Hospital and was given a prosthetic limb attached to his left lower leg.

Sumit discovered para sports after meeting another para athlete, Rajkumar, during his B.Com. education in Ramjas College, Delhi. This is also when he met his coaches, Virender Dhankar — who won the shot put silver medal at the 2018 Asian Games — and Naval Singh.

One of the first things he asked the duo then was what the world record was in javelin throw. His coaches chided him for such lofty ambitions then, but little did they know that he would go on to reset the world record eight times in the next five-odd years.

Sumit defended his gold medal in the Paris Summer Games with another Paralympic record — a massive 70.59m throw. This despite nursing a recurring back injury. He wanted another world record mark but couldn't push hard enough to go past his own record of 73.29m, which he set at the Hangzhou Asian Para Games.

Sumit is the first Indian man to successfully defend his Paralympic title and is eyeing a historic three-peat in Los Angeles in 2028.



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